

» FROM THE WORLD OF FOOTBALL

In memoriam: In a poignant scene, Liverpool captain Virgil van Dijk shared a tender moment with Diogo Jota's children as the entire stadium paid its respects to the late star. AFP



A NIGHT OF EMOTIONS

Anfield unites in tribute as Liverpool and Wolves **honour** the late Diogo Jota.



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The Premier League witnessed a heartfelt moment ahead of Liverpool's fixture against Wolverhampton Wanderers when two of Diogo Jota's children, Dinis and Duarte, as well as other family members, played the role of mascots at Anfield as the club paid tribute to the late forward.

Jota, who lost his life in a car accident in July, joined Liverpool from Wolves in 2020. In the first meeting between the sides since his death, both sets of fans paid their respects (**facing page, top**), including a chant in Jota's name in the 20th minute.

The scenes leading up to the clash and the gestures on the field transcended football and showed why the sport is known as 'The Beautiful Game'.

Liverpool won the match 2-1 with goals from Ryan Gravenberch and Florian Wirtz, with Gravenberch honouring Jota by performing

his trademark celebration after scoring.

The Premier League title race is shaping up to be an exciting one. By the looks of it, three clubs are currently in contention — Arsenal, Manchester City and surprise entrant Aston Villa, which won its 11th game on the trot courtesy of an impressive 2-1 comeback win against Chelsea.

While Joao Pedro found a rare Premier League goal to put the Blues ahead, Ollie Watkins scored a brace to keep Villa's winning streak alive and the club in the title race.

Arsenal, widely tipped to win the